

Ours The federal government has "77 different means-tested **social** welfare programs. Rep. Jim Jordan chairs an influential group, the Republican Study Committee, at an opportune time. The group's political beliefs generally intersect with those of the Tea Party, and they include a desire to stop wasteful government spending. Among the targets: redundant social welfare programs. You might know these as food stamps and Temporary Assistance to **Needy Families**, but Jordan, of Urbana, Ohio, says there are a whole lot more than that. Jordan counts 77 federal means-tested social welfare programs, citing that number during an interview on the FOX Business Network and in backup materials to support one of his bills. "There are seven -- this is according to Heritage Foundation, we get a list of these -- 77 different means tested social welfare programs -- 77 different ones," Jordan said during a March 22 appearance on Fox. A week earlier he had introduced his **Welfare Reform Act of 2011**, which would require a full accounting of each social welfare program. It also would require food stamp recipients to work or prepare for a job, much as welfare reform under President Bill Clinton required of cash aid recipients. And it would require **federal** welfare spending to return to pre-recession levels, with allowance for inflation growth, once the unemployment rate fell to 6.5 percent. The sheer number that Jordan cited -- 77 separate welfare programs -- sounded extraordinary, so PolitiFact Ohio took a look. Jordan's office had a list with all 77 programs. Space limits our ability to include all here, and Jordan's list is not online. You can find them in Jordan's bill, or watch as they scroll across the screen on this Republican Study Committee video. They include Medicaid, food stamps, Section 8 housing assistance; weatherization help for home owners and Pell **grants** to help students afford college. Jordan's list also includes low-income home energy assistance, school breakfast for children from low-income families, the Job Corps training program for at-risk teens and young adults, and Head Start for pre-kindergartners. Most of the programs are geared toward people who fall below a certain income level. But Jordan's list also included at least a dozen programs that don't give federal money or services directly to the poor. Some examples: the **Appalachian Regional Commission**; urban development block grants; Title 1 education grants that help schools in low-income areas; empowerment zones, which typically benefit businesses as well as communities, and Americ

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